REAR SUSPENSION KNUCKLE REPLACEMENT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: **CERTAIN 1999 AND 2000 MODEL YEAR SVT MUSTANG COBRA AND CERTAIN 2000 MODEL YEAR SVT MUSTANG COBRA R VEHICLES**

OVERVIEW

This procedure provides the instructions for replacing both rear suspension knuckles on the affected vehicles. New fasteners, which are provided in the repair kit, must be used during installation to ensure a complete repair.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

NOTE: Replace both the left and right rear suspension knuckles on all vehicles. Remember to use all of the new fasteners included in the service kit. The service procedure for both sides is identical.

REMOVAL

1. Raise the vehicle on a hoist.
2. Remove the wheel and tire.
3. Disconnect the parking brake cable from the brake caliper lever. See Figure 1.
4. NOTE: The parking brake cable conduit must be separated from the brake caliper to access the caliper anchor bolts.

   Remove the retaining clip from the parking brake cable conduit, then separate the conduit from the caliper. See Figure 1.

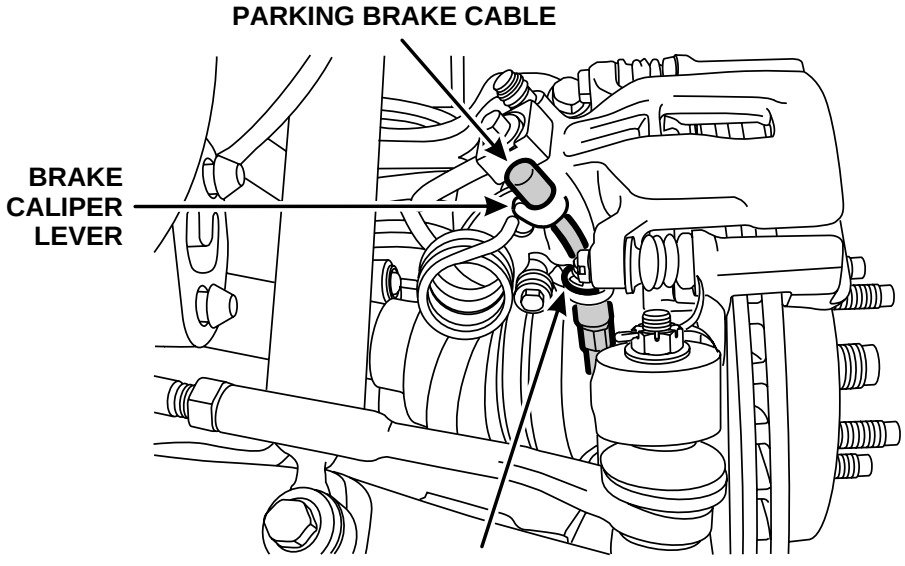


FIGURE 1

Ford Motor Company
CPR © 2001 FORD MOTOR COMPANY
DEARBORN, MICHIGAN 48121
04/01

5. Route the parking brake cable conduit through the guide loop on the back of the rear suspension knuckle.

CAUTION:

THE BRAKE CALIPER/ANCHOR PLATE MUST BE SUPPORTED AT ALL TIMES. DO NOT ALLOW THE BRAKE CALIPER/ANCHOR PLATE TO HANG FROM THE BRAKE HOSE.

6. Remove and discard the brake caliper anchor mounting bolts. Remove the brake caliper and anchor plate as an assembly and support them with a short length of mechanics wire. See Figure 2.
7. Remove the brake rotor. See Figure 2.
8. Remove and discard the rear hub retainer from the axle shaft.
9. Remove and discard the cotter pin and castle nut from the toe link. See Figure 2.

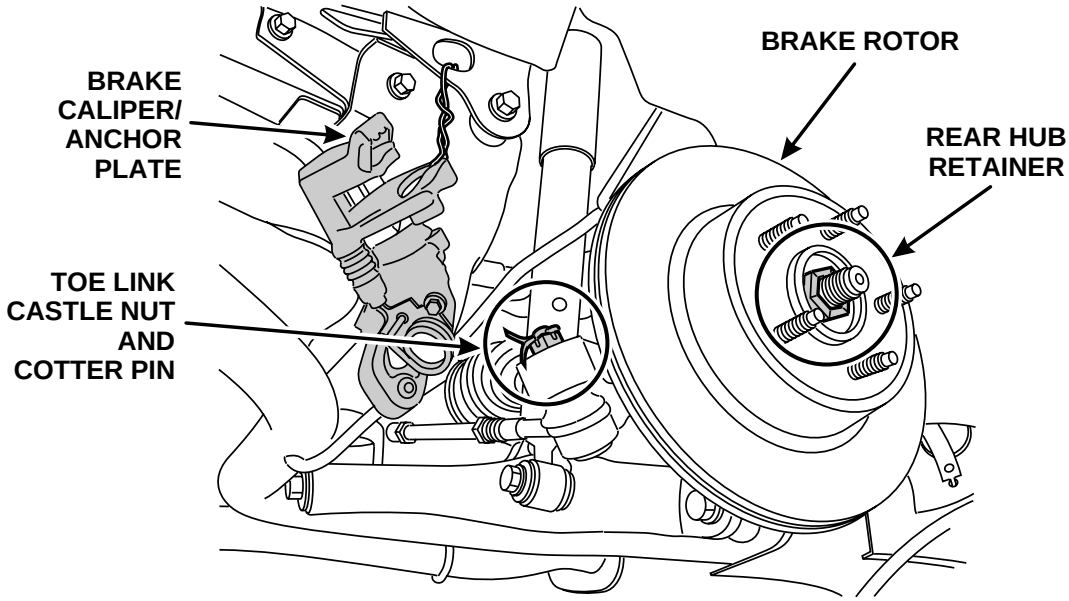


FIGURE 2

Ford Motor Company
CPR © 2001 FORD MOTOR COMPANY
DEARBORN, MICHIGAN 48121
04/01

10. **CAUTION: Do not strike the toe link or knuckle. The toe link may be damaged.**

    NOTE: The toe link cannot be fully removed from the knuckle until after the upper ball joint is disconnected from the control arm.

    Separate the toe link from the rear suspension knuckle using Steering Arm Remover (T64P-9171-A). See Figure 3.

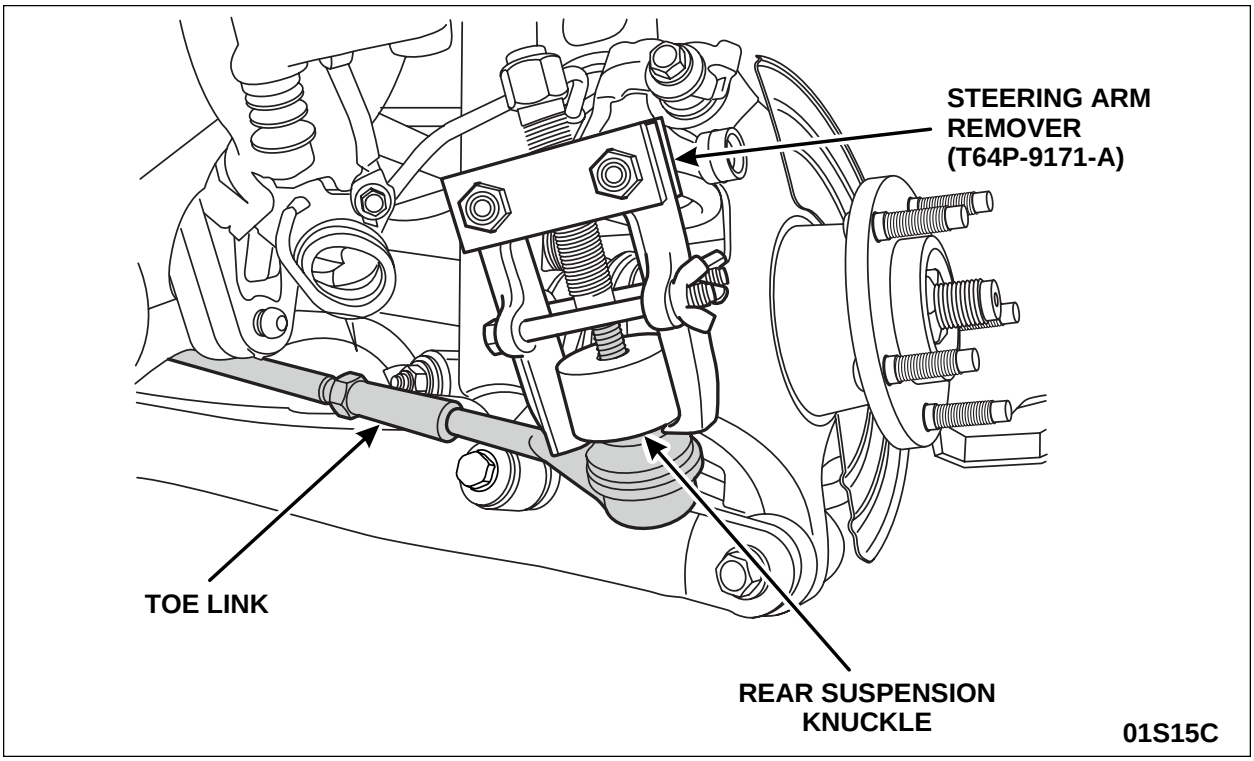


FIGURE 3

Ford Motor Company
CPR © 2001 FORD MOTOR COMPANY
DEARBORN, MICHIGAN 48121
04/01

11. Place a reference mark for reassembly on the upper ball joint cam bolt and the upper control arm. See Figure 4.
12. Hold the cam bolt with a wrench and remove the nut. Remove the cam bolt and transfer the reference mark onto a new cam bolt, then discard the original cam bolt and nut. See Figure 4.

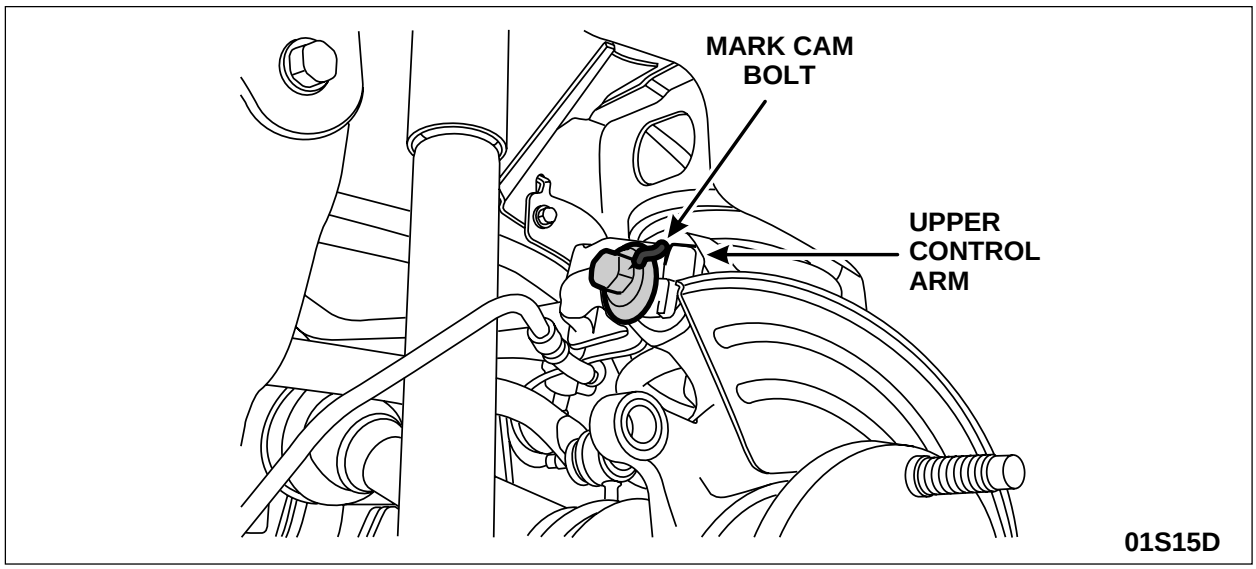


FIGURE 4

13. Rotate the top of the knuckle towards the front of the vehicle and remove the toe link from the knuckle.
14. Press the rear axle shaft from the hub using Hub Remover (D93P-1175-B) or equivalent. See Figure 5.
15. Remove and discard the lower ball joint bolt, nut and rear suspension knuckle. See Figure 5.

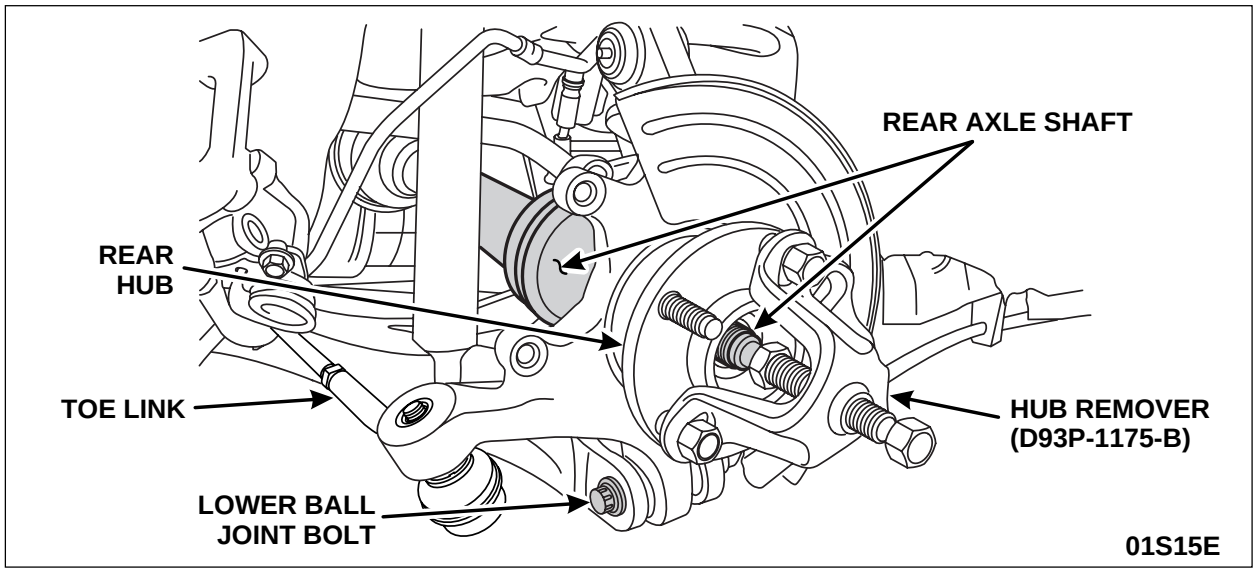


FIGURE 5

Ford Motor Company
CPR © 2001 FORD MOTOR COMPANY
DEARBORN, MICHIGAN 48121
04/01

INSTALLATION

1. Position the new rear suspension knuckle onto the lower control arm and install a new bolt and nut. Tighten the bolt to 115 Nm (85 lb-ft).
2. Slide the axle shaft into the back of the hub making sure the splines on the axle shaft align with the splines in the hub.
3. Install a new hub retainer onto the axle shaft. Do not tighten at this time.
4. Connect the toe link to the rear suspension knuckle and loosely install a new castle nut.
5. Position the top of the new rear suspension knuckle into the upper control arm. Install the new cam bolt and nut.
6. Align the mark on the new cam bolt and the upper control arm. Tighten the nut to 90 Nm (66 lb-ft).
7. Tighten the new toe link castle nut to 47 Nm (35 lb-ft). Install a new cotter pin.
8. Install the brake rotor.
9. Install the brake caliper/anchor plate using new bolts. Tighten the bolts to 103 Nm (76 lb-ft).
10. Route the parking brake cable conduit through the guide loop on the knuckle.
11. Connect the parking brake cable conduit to the brake caliper.
12. Install the retaining clip on the parking brake cable conduit.
13. Connect the parking brake cable to the brake caliper lever.
14. **CAUTION: The hub retainer must be tightened with the brakes applied and the wheels off of the ground to make sure of correct bearing seating. Failure to do so can cause the retainer to loosen causing extensive vehicle damage and potential loss of vehicle control.**

    Partially lower the vehicle to access the parking brake handle and fully apply the parking brake. Tighten the hub retainer nut to 325 Nm (240 lb-ft).
15. Install the wheel and tire. Tighten the nuts to 129 Nm (95 lb-ft).
16. Lower the vehicle.
17. Check the wheel alignment and adjust as necessary.

Ford Motor Company

CPR © 2001 FORD MOTOR COMPANY
DEARBORN, MICHIGAN 48121
04/01